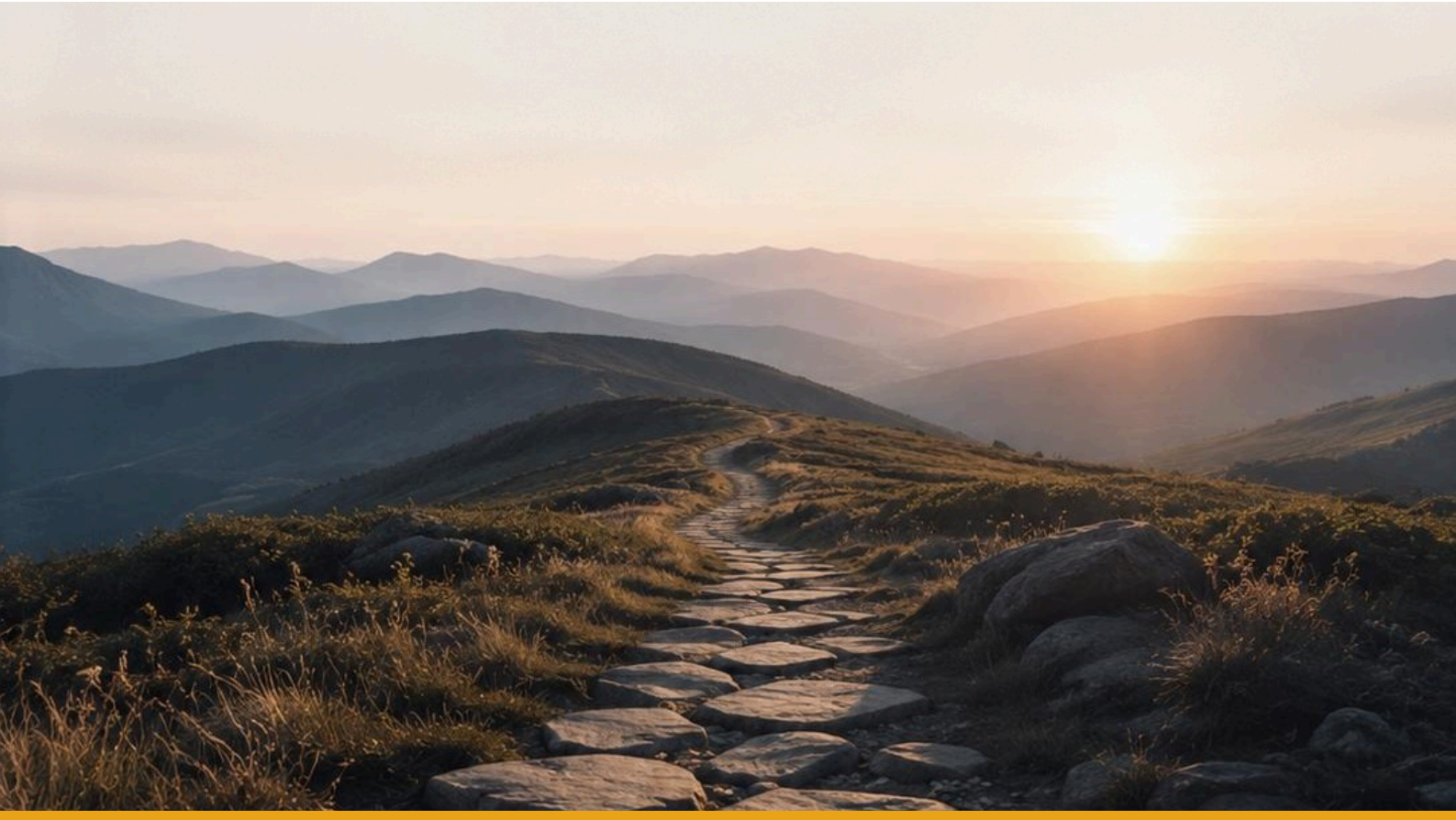
ALDENHAM
— EDUCATION GROUP —



AEG INSTITUTE OF LEADERSHIP

Welcome to the story of your leadership...

The Call to Leadership

A day that changes how your leaders lead.

AT A GLANCE

What is The Call to Leadership?

A one-day leadership development course for your team, offered by the AEG Institute of Leadership.

Its core material is drawn from the psychology of how adults develop as leaders. Every course is then adjusted to your school or organisation, shaped around the real leadership needs of your team.

DURATION

One day, plus follow-up support

GROUP SIZE

6 to 24 participants

FORMAT

Workshop in person at your venue; commissioning conversations and follow-up sessions can be online

DESIGNED FOR

Schools, organisations and their leadership teams

FOLLOW-UP

Partner check-ins and 90-minute follow-up sessions

CERTIFICATION

Certificate of completion from the AEG Institute of Leadership

Who should attend

- **Emerging leaders** taking on responsibility for people for the first time
- **Developing leaders** in middle leadership, ready to widen their range
- **Senior leaders** who set the culture others work within
- **Leaders new to a role** who want a clear model for the step up
- **Whole teams** who want to work together more effectively

> *Our mission is to empower leaders at every level.*
>
> AEG INSTITUTE OF LEADERSHIP

A different kind of leadership course

I Coherent learning, not disparate tools

Many courses hand leaders a scattering of tools. The Call to Leadership rests on one coherent model: Integral Theory, the metatheory of psychological development. Participants construct the theory themselves, through experiential activities and discussion, so it stays with them.

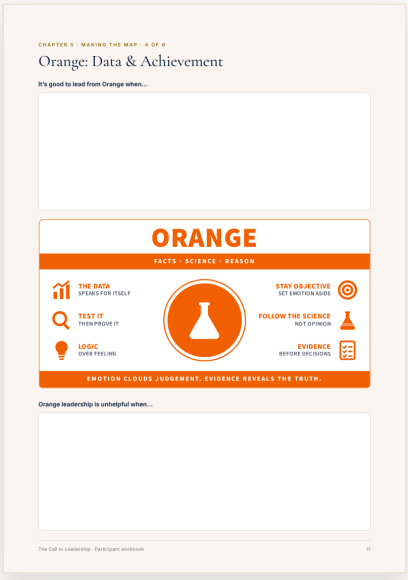
II A powerful way of learning

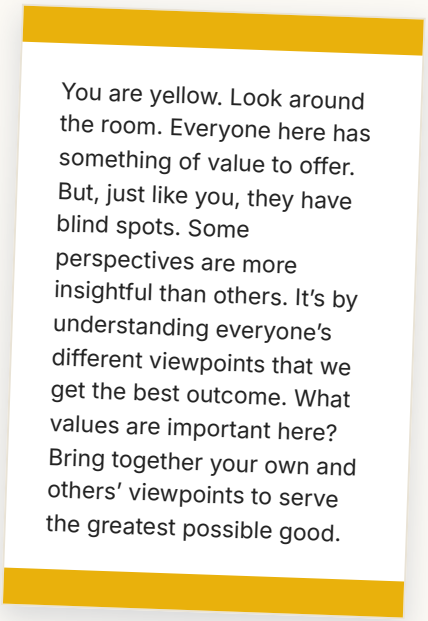
No slide decks. Story is the vehicle: participants set out on a hero's journey, with game-based experiences, plenty of rich discussion and a structured workbook that captures the learning as they go.

III Bespoke impact

The course is designed to adapt. We emphasise what matters most to you in three ways: focusing on the areas of leadership your team most needs, adding practical leadership tools, and building case studies from your real challenges.







The journey begins with a map, each colour is explored in turn, and every participant plays a secret card.

HOW THE DAY UNFOLDS

A day with a clear structure

The day follows the shape of a classic story: a call, a challenge and a return. Narrative structure is a powerful way for adults to reflect honestly and remember what they learn, and every stage has a clear professional purpose.



The participant map, annotated with each leader's own challenges

1 **Surfacing resistance**
Refusing the call. Leaders name the reasons the day might not help them; the day returns to these at the end.

2 **Introducing the model**
Meet the mentor. A research-based map of how adults continue to develop as leaders.

3 **Experiencing difference**
The discussion game. Each participant argues from a secret colour card, and the room sees how differently good people approach the same problem.

4 **Building the model**
The reveal. What each perspective offers and where it falls short; participants construct the model themselves.

5 **Diagnosing your organisation**
A gleaming palace. Its centre of gravity, what helps it and what holds it back.

6 **Personal challenge**
The dragon's lair. Each leader examines where they lead from too narrow a view.

7 **Clarifying values**
The treasure. What matters most, and the behaviours that show it or undermine it.

8 **Committing to change**
The journey home. Commitments, an accountability partner and a plan for next week.



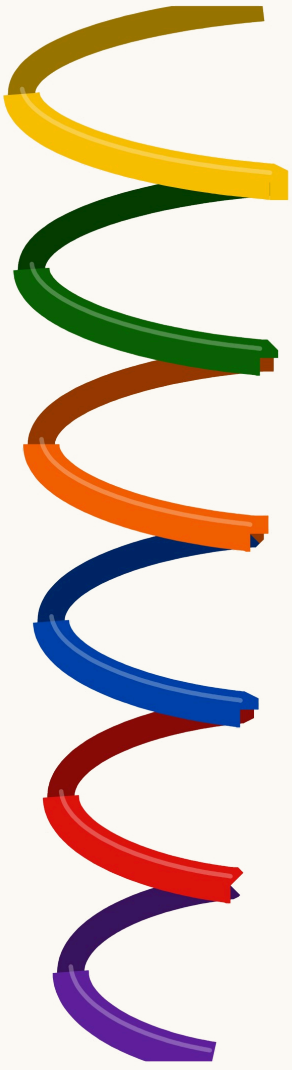
A structured workbook

Every participant works through a structured workbook. It captures their reflections on each stage, their personal commitments and the questions an accountability partner will ask them in the weeks that follow.

BESPOKE BY DESIGN · 1

Address the challenges your team actually faces

Because the course is built on a comprehensive theory of human development, it can be aimed precisely at the leadership challenges your own team faces. In our commissioning conversations we pinpoint the areas behind your challenges, and shape the day to address them directly.



Seeing the Whole System

Perspective · flexibility · integration

+ Big-picture thinking that never lands in day-to-day practice.
– Teams work in silos; a fix in one area creates problems in another.

Everyone Matters

Listening · inclusion · consensus

+ Endless consultation; hard conversations avoided to keep the peace.
– Quieter voices go unheard; people feel managed rather than valued.

Data & Achievement

Results · evidence · improvement

+ Targets come before people: pressure, burnout and box-ticking.
– Decisions by habit or opinion; no clear goals or evidence of impact.

Order & Duty

Structure · standards · responsibility

+ Rigid rules and slow decisions; initiative is quietly discouraged.
– Inconsistent standards, unclear roles, policies nobody follows.

I Want to Win

Energy · courage · decisiveness

+ Leaders who dominate, or chase personal wins at the organisation's expense.
– Leaders who hesitate, avoid tough calls and let problems drift.

Belonging

Loyalty · family · shared identity

+ Closed circles, 'how we've always done it', loyalty that shields poor performance.
– New colleagues never feel part of things; trust stays low.

Under-developed · *– not enough* Healthy expression · *the balance point* Shadow side · *+ too much*

BESPOKE BY DESIGN · 2

Add the leadership tools you need

Based on the issues your team is facing, the course can include a range of further leadership tools.

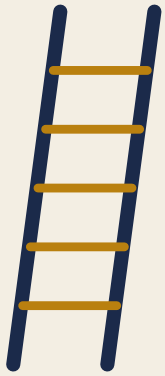
Tools are available for:

- **Leading change**
- **Effective delegation →**
- **Tackling poor performance**
- **Effective line management**
- *...your issue*

The responsibility ladder

Tick the approach that fits the task and the person.

Team member decides and acts	6	☐
Team member decides, then informs	5	☐
Leader and team member decide together	4	☐
Team member recommends; leader decides	3	■
Leader consults, then decides	2	☐
Leader decides and announces	1	☐



More ownership with the team as you climb ↑

BESPOKE BY DESIGN · 3

Learn through your own case studies

Our commissioning conversations can develop case studies based on the real issues your team is facing.

Participants then apply the model to situations they recognise, which makes the discussion sharper and the learning easier to carry back to work.



WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

Growth for the individual and the organisation

By the end of the course and its follow-up, participants and their organisation will:

The individual will…

Gain a clear map of how leaders develop.

Strengthen self-awareness through structured, honest reflection.

Learn to recognise the worldviews behind colleagues' behaviour.

Build the range to lead differently when the situation demands it.

Tackle difficult situations with greater calm and flexibility.

Turn insight into specific commitments and experiments.

The organisation will…

Develop a shared language for leadership across teams.

Engage leaders with the real challenges you face.

Connect individual growth to organisational priorities.

Strengthen accountability through agreed, measurable success criteria.

Turn conflict into understanding.

Apply the learning across the organisation, with follow-up built in.

WHAT PARTICIPANTS TAKE AWAY

- Their workbook
- Personal commitments
- A shared language
- A map for further growth
- A certificate

HOW YOU WILL LEARN

Active, story-driven and grounded in research

A story-led journey
The day unfolds as a hero's quest.

A discussion game
Each participant argues from a secret colour card.

Collaboration
In pairs, small groups and as a whole team.

Personal reflection
Guided, honest thinking about your own leadership.

A structured workbook
Captures thinking and commitments as you go.

Your case studies
Real issues from your own organisation.

Accountability partners
Colleagues help keep each other on track.

Follow-up sessions
Commitments revisited after the day.

YOUR LEARNING EXPERIENCE

Before, during and after the day

1 Before

- Commissioning conversations
- Success criteria agreed
- Content and case studies shaped to your team

2 On the day

- The discussion game: arguing from six perspectives
- The reveal: what each perspective offers, and where it falls short
- Building the map: participants construct the model themselves
- Applying it: your organisation, your leadership, your values
- Commitments to change, and an accountability partner

3 After

- Partner check-ins at two and four weeks
- 90-minute follow-up sessions after one, two and/or three months
- Optional individual coaching

ACCOUNTABILITY AND IMPACT

Learning that lasts beyond the day

The way we focus on accountability depends on your organisation's unique culture. However it is done, The Call to Leadership doesn't end when the workshop is complete.

Rubrics for success

Clear, measurable criteria agreed with you before the course begins.

Reflective writing

Participants write about their leadership development and its impact on the organisation.

Evidence collection

Leaders note real examples of the behaviours they are building.

A circular structure

The day returns to where it began, with explicit activities that surface, and dispel, resistance to change.

Accountability partnering

Each participant writes three questions for a chosen colleague or line manager to ask after two, then four weeks.

Follow-up sessions

The day ends with commitments to change or experiment. We return to them in 90-minute sessions after one, two and/or three months.

EXAMPLE · SUCCESS CRITERIA AGREED BEFORE THE COURSE

FOCUS	BEGINNING	DEVELOPING	STRONG IMPACT
Listening	Tends to listen mainly to respond.	Listens carefully and asks questions.	Helps others feel heard and understood.
Openness to other views	Finds disagreement uncomfortable.	Considers different viewpoints.	Actively welcomes challenge and different perspectives.
Handling conflict	May become defensive or avoid challenge.	Responds calmly during disagreement.	Uses difficult conversations to build trust.

THE PATH TO LASTING CHANGE

Before the course to three months after

1 **Before** — Success criteria agreed

2 **The day** — Commitments formed

3 **Week 2** — Partner check-in

4 **Week 4** — Partner check-in

5 **Months 1–3** — Follow-up sessions

WORKING TOGETHER

From first conversation to lasting change

1

Commissioning conversations

Understanding your team, your culture and your priorities.

2

Session design

Tailored to your context, with case studies where useful.

3

Delivery

A full-day workshop for your leaders, at your venue.

4

Follow-up

Reflection and accountability structures keep the learning live.

What's included

The Call to Leadership

One-day course for 6 to 24 participants, with workbooks and certificates

Commissioning conversations

Before the course, to agree success criteria and shape the content

Follow-up sessions

90 minutes revisiting commitments made on the course; in person or online

Individual coaching

To embed change: 4 to 6 sessions of 45–60 minutes, weekly or fortnightly

> Pricing depends on group size and the follow-up you choose. After our first conversation, you'll receive a clear proposal for your team.

CERTIFICATION

Recognised by the AEG Institute of Leadership

Every participant who completes the course receives a certificate of completion issued by the AEG Institute of Leadership.



QUESTIONS

Frequently asked questions

Is it only for schools?

No. The course grew out of developing school leaders, and it works for any leadership team: schools, trusts, charities and businesses. The case studies and examples are shaped to your context.

Can the boss attend alongside their team?

Yes, but with care. A charismatic, pace-setting leader may discourage colleagues from participating fully, so it is often better to arrange cohorts at a similar level: emerging, developing or senior leadership teams.

Can it be run online?

The workshop itself is delivered in person. Commissioning conversations and follow-up sessions can be held online.

Where does the course take place?

At your venue. If you would prefer to take your team off-site, we can help you find somewhere suitable.

What do participants need to prepare?

Nothing. The commissioning conversations beforehand let us aim the learning at the real issues in your team, and potentially write case studies for discussion.

What do participants take away?

Their workbook and commitments, a shared language for leadership, a framework for their further development and a certificate of completion.

How will we know it has worked?

Success criteria are agreed transparently before the course, then supported by reflective writing, evidence of new behaviours, accountability partners and follow-up sessions.

How is this different from personality-type training?

Type tools sort people into fixed categories. The Call to Leadership offers a picture of what developed leadership looks like, and a path towards it that every leader can follow.



Every quest begins with a conversation.

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ABOUT US

AEG Institute of Leadership

Aldenham Education Group is a global education organisation that develops, acquires and manages K–12 schools and early years centres. Its heritage lies in two historic schools in the UK, including Aldenham School in Hertfordshire, founded in 1597, and the group runs schools and academies internationally.

The AEG Institute of Leadership brings the group's experience of developing leaders to schools and organisations in the UK and beyond.

ALDENHAM
EDUCATION GROUP

MANAGING PARTNERS, ALDENHAM EDUCATION GROUP

Headshot

Shahram Hashemi

CO-FOUNDER AND MANAGING PARTNER

Moved into education from private equity, inspired by his father's lifelong commitment to teaching. A graduate of Chicago Booth.

Headshot

Alec H. Nejad

CO-FOUNDER AND MANAGING PARTNER

Brings extensive experience in operations, building start-up businesses, investment banking, real estate and finance. He attended the Kellogg School of Management.

COURSE DIRECTOR



Luke Harding

Luke is Director of Education at Aldenham Education Group. He brings more than 20 years' experience in education across the UK, Italy and Thailand, including a decade in senior leadership. He holds a First Class degree in English from Oxford and an MBA in Educational Leadership (Distinction) from UCL, is a qualified Level 5 professional coach, and has examined for AQA and KCL.

Continue the conversation

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